# ASEEL ADDAWOOD, PHD

AI STRATEGY & INNOVATION LEADERSHIP | DRIVING BUSINESS TRANSFORMATION | EMERGING TECHNOLOGY SOLUTIONS | AI ECOSYSTEMS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

## CONTACTS


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## CORE COMPETENCIES

**AI Strategy & Innovation Leadership**
- AI Strategy & Implementation
- Applied Machine Learning & NLP
- AI Governance & Ethical AI
- Data-Driven Decision Making
- Innovation Roadmapping

**Business Transformation**
- Executive Leadership & Change Management
- Vision 2030 Strategic Alignment
- Public Sector Digital Transformation
- KPI Optimization & Performance Management

**Emerging Technology**
- Cloud Architecture (OCI)
- Intelligent Automation
- Digital Infrastructure Modernization
- Python for Data Science

**AI Ecosystems & Thought Leadership**
- AI Talent Development & Upskilling
- Startup Ecosystem Enablement
- Cross-Sector Strategic Partnerships
- Public Speaking & AI Advocacy

## EDUCATION

**UNIVERSITY OF ILLINOIS URBANA-CHAMPAIGN (UIUC)**
**Champaign–Urban, IL, USA**
Ph.D. in Informatics, 2019
(Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society)
M.S. in Information Management, 2018

**CORNELL UNIVERSITY (CU)**
**Ithaca, NY, USA**
M.Eng. in Computer Engineering, 2013

**KING SAUD UNIVERSITY (KSU)**
**Riyadh, KSA**
B.S. in Information Technology, 2010
(Second Class Honors)

## PROFILE

Visionary AI leader with over 14 years of cross-industry experience in enterprise AI strategy, digital transformation, and scalable technology adoption. Expertise in delivering cloud-native AI, machine learning solutions, NLP advancements, and localized AI for global impact. Recognized for driving high-impact initiatives, aligning AI strategies with business goals, and empowering cross-functional teams to deliver measurable outcomes. Featured in AI Magazine and SRMG Think; speaker at Step Conference and WiDS KSA with more than 50K attendees. U.S.-trained Ph.D. and active member of IEEE, AAAI, and ACM, with culturally agile leadership fostering collaboration across diverse industries. Dedicated to accelerating digital transformation, sustainable ecosystem growth, and mentoring future technology leaders through advocacy and thought leadership.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**ORACLE | Riyadh, KSA**
**KSA leader, EMEA AI center of excellence, April 2025 - Present**
**Europe, Middle East & Africa (EMEA) AI Leader, Dec 2023 – April 2025**
- Accelerated AI transformation for over 30 high-profile local clients—including the Digital Government Authority and the Ministry of Municipal and Rural Affairs—by developing enterprise-wide AI strategies and scalable, domain-specific AI use cases
- Delivered AI enablement programs across KSA and EMEA, training over 1,000 Oracle employees through workshops on data science, AI adoption, and customer engagement strategies
- Improved public sector automation and efficiency by advising multiple global customers such as the Spanish Ministry of Justice on AI integration and delivering use-case-driven recommendations
- Strengthened Oracle KSA's positioning as a cloud and AI innovation leader by establishing an internal AI task force, aligning strategic priorities, and enhancing organizational capabilities

**MINISTRY OF ENERGY (MOE) | Riyadh, KSA**
**Director of Emerging Technology, AI & Data Analytics Advisor**
**Mar 2021 – Dec 2023**
- Established the Emerging Technology Department, delivering 8 national AI initiatives and defining frameworks for data governance and operational excellence to advance AI adoption within the energy sector
- Led digital transformation efforts by driving AI and data analytics adoption across government operations via change management and digital literacy programs
- Developed initiatives to support AI startups in the energy sector, successfully assisting more than 10 companies in adopting and advancing AI solutions

**ORACLE | Riyadh, KSA**
**Senior Regional Data Consultant & Senior Cloud Engineer, Aug 2020 – Aug 2022**
- Delivered cloud-based AI and advanced analytics solutions across META, driving enterprise digital transformation and aligning use cases with business objectives
- Increased Oracle Cloud adoption by delivering machine learning proof-of-concepts for multiple customers—including MoMRA—using Python-based solutions

**Senior Cloud Engineer, Aug 2020 – Dec 2020**
- Identified AI-driven automation opportunities for more than 100 cross-sector clients, optimizing workflows and enhancing operational efficiencies
- Boosted stakeholder engagement and presales alignment by leading internal enablement initiatives for AI-driven cloud engineering solutions

**IMAM MOHAMMAD IBN SAUD UNIVERSITY (IMISU) | Riyadh, KSA**
**Assistant Professor, Aug 2019 – Dec 2022**
**Teaching Assistant (TA), Dec 2010 – Aug 2019**
- Designed and delivered AI-focused computer science curricula, and launched the university's first AI student club to foster industry readiness

**UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA (USC) | Los Angeles, CA, USA**
**Visiting Researcher, Jul 2018 – Sep 2018**

## AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

- **Women in Tech Global Award**
  Women in Data Science (WiDS) International, 2024
- **Top 10 Women in AI in MEA**
  AI Magazine, 2023
- **Customer Advocate Award**
  Oracle, 2021
- **Hackathon Finalist – Oracle MAdHack**
  Oracle, 2020
- **Computing Advancement Grant**
  CRA-W, 2018
- **Conference Travel Grant**
  ICWSM, 2019
- **Leadership Scholarship**
  Arab Women in Computing, 2017
- **Research Fellowship Award**
  Women in Machine Learning Workshop, 2017

## FELLOWSHIPS & MEMBERSHIPS

**THE SAUDI STANDARDS, METROLOGY, & QUALITY ORGANIZATION (SASO)**
**Riyadh, KSA**
Board Member, Aug 2023 – Present

**TAIBAH UNIVERSITY**
**Madinah, KSA**
Board Member, Feb 2023 – Present

**TECHNICAL & VOCATIONAL TRAINING CORPORATION (TVTC)**
**Riyadh, KSA**
Steering Board Member,
Aug 2022 – Present

**WOMEN IN INNOVATION, ATLANTIC COUNCIL & GEORGETOWN UNIVERSITY**
Fellow, Apr 2022 – Present

## CERTIFICATIONS

- Infrastructure Certified Architect Associate (OCI-AA)
- Autonomous Database Cloud Specialist (ADB)
- Infrastructure Foundations Certified Associate (OCI-F)

## SPECIAL ENGAGEMENTS

**SORTERA | Riyadh, KSA**
**Chairman of the Board, Aug 2022 – Present**
Created oversight for an AI-powered initiative for industrial material sorting and recycling, improving efficiency, reducing waste, and supporting the economy

**SEETECH | Riyadh, KSA**
**Chairman of the Board, Feb 2022 – Present**
Led strategic direction for an initiative advancing AI-driven smart city solutions using data analytics, IoT, and predictive modeling

**MONSHA'AT | Riyadh, KSA**
**Technical Consultant, May 2020 – Jun 2021**
Enabled more than 15 startups to integrate AI and emerging technologies into their solutions, driving innovation and scalability

**BAYAN ACADEMY | Riyadh, KSA**
**Chairman of the Board, Apr 2020 – Present**
Launched strategic leadership for an Arabic-language AI and data science education initiative, expanding access and empowering regional talent

**BAYAN | Riyadh, KSA**
**Chairman of the Board, Aug 2019 – Present**
- Advanced AI localization in Saudi Arabia through strategic oversight, team growth, and alignment with global AI strategies

## LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY IMPACT

**1932 PROJECT | Riyadh, KSA**
**Mentor, Apr 2022 – Present**
- Mentored young women in technology through Big Sib, fostering growth, confidence, and leadership in the tech industry

**ARABWIC KSA | Riyadh, KSA**
**President, Mar 2020 – Sep 2023**
- Supported women in tech by organizing AI and cloud-focused webinars, mentoring programs, and career development initiatives to promote gender diversity in STEM

**WOMEN WHO CODE (WWCODE) | Chicago, IL, USA**
**Director, May 2017 – Aug 2018**
- Upskilled early-career professionals through AI and machine learning workshops, fostering technical expertise in data science and software engineering

## PUBLICATIONS

- Published **over 15 peer-reviewed papers** in computational social science, social computing, NLP, and health informatics, garnering over 520 citations
- Authored *A Renewed Birth*, an Arabic-language book, along with thought pieces on AI and digital transformation for Nmthgiat.com, exploring the societal impact of emerging technologies
- Contributed to the Saudi Research and Media Group (SRMG) *MENA Outlook 2025* report, providing insights on regional innovation and digital transformation trends

## FEATURED SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

Participated in **over 50 local and global speaking engagements**, including panels discussions, talks, and podcasts such as:
- Women in Data Science (WiDS) Ambassador, 2022 – Present
- Step Conference, Dubai & Riyadh, 2025
- SPE AI Symposium, 2025